Ichigo — Project Development & Documentation

1. Executive Summary

Ichigo is a social feedback platform where users post thoughts, wins, worries, conflicts, questions, or decisions and choose the type of response they are emotionally ready to receive.

Unlike conventional social media, where feedback is unpredictable and often emotionally harmful, Ichigo introduces an explicit **response mode** system. Each post carries an emotional contract such as **Hype Me**, **Comfort Me**, **Advise Me**, **Soft Truth**, or **Challenge Me**. Other users respond within that contract, and the platform rewards people who respect it.

Ichigo is built around one core insight:

> People do not always want raw public opinion. Often, they want the right kind of feedback for their current emotional state.

The product does not aim to create delusion, secretly manipulate users, or falsify reality. Instead, it gives users agency over the emotional frame of their social interactions.

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2. Product Thesis

2.1 Core Belief

Human beings seek validation, reassurance, encouragement, social approval, correction, and belonging. Traditional social platforms exploit this desire indirectly through likes, comments, follower counts, reposts, and algorithmic ranking.

Ichigo makes the emotional need explicit, structured, and consent-based.

2.2 Problem Statement

People often share online without receiving the kind of response they actually need.

Examples:

- Someone shares a win and receives sarcasm or criticism.
- Someone vents and receives unsolicited advice.
- Someone asks for advice and receives empty praise.
- Someone wants honest feedback but receives performative support.
- Someone posts publicly and becomes emotionally harmed by random hostile comments.

The mismatch between what a person emotionally needs and what the internet gives them creates anxiety, defensiveness, loneliness, and reduced willingness to share honestly.

2.3 Product Solution

Ichigo lets users define the expected response style before the interaction begins.

A post is not just content. It is content plus context:

> “Here is what I am sharing, and here is how I want people to engage with me.”

This creates healthier social interaction by aligning expectations between poster and responder.

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3. Vision

To become the default platform for emotionally intentional social feedback.

Ichigo should feel like a place where users can share without being randomly attacked, misunderstood, or emotionally mismatched.

The long-term vision is to build a social network where people are rewarded not for being the loudest, harshest, or most viral, but for responding in the way another person explicitly asked to be met.

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4. Mission Statement

Ichigo helps people receive the kind of feedback they are emotionally ready for.

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5. Positioning

5.1 One-Line Pitch

Ichigo is a social app where every post has a response mode, so people receive feedback that matches what they actually need.

5.2 Short Pitch

Ichigo lets users post anything — a win, worry, question, conflict, decision, or thought — and choose how others should respond: hype, comfort, advice, soft truth, or challenge. The community is rewarded for respecting the chosen response mode.

5.3 Category

Ichigo sits between:

- Anonymous social apps
- Emotional support communities
- Social media comment systems
- AI-assisted reflection tools
- Peer advice platforms

But its unique category can be defined as:

> **Intentional feedback social platform**

or

> **Emotion-aware social feedback app**

5.4 Core Brand Statement

> **A post is not just content. It is content plus context.**

This statement captures Ichigo's central difference from conventional social media.

Most platforms focus on what the user says. Ichigo focuses on both what the user says and how they want others to respond.

Conventional social media asks:

> What do you want to say?

Ichigo asks:

> What do you want to say, and how do you want people to meet you?

This should become one of Ichigo's foundational brand statements and can be used in pitch decks, landing pages, onboarding, investor conversations, and public interviews.

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6. Name: Ichigo

6.1 Working Interpretation

"Ichigo" can be treated as a memorable, soft, emotionally warm brand name. It is short, easy to say, and has a gentle feel.

Depending on brand direction, Ichigo can represent:

- A safe place to be seen
- A small emotional fruit or sweetness metaphor
- A personal social garden
- A space for soft but meaningful human feedback

6.2 Brand Feel

Ichigo should feel:

- Warm
- Safe
- Human
- Slightly playful
- Emotionally intelligent
- Not clinical
- Not manipulative
- Not childish

6.3 Possible Taglines

- “Choose how the world responds.”
- “Feedback that meets you where you are.”
- “Say what you need. Receive what helps.”
- “Your post. Your emotional context.”
- “A better way to be heard.”
- “Where feedback has feelings.”

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7. Target Users

7.1 Primary Users

Emotionally expressive social users

People who already post online, journal, vent, seek advice, or share personal moments but dislike the randomness of public feedback.

They may use:

- X/Twitter
- TikTok
- Reddit
- Instagram
- Threads
- NGL-style apps

- Anonymous confession apps
- AI companion apps

Young adults and students

Users navigating identity, friendships, relationships, school, career anxiety, social comparison, and self-worth.

They often want feedback, but not always harsh public judgment.

Creators and builders

People who share work, ideas, projects, bug bounty reports, writing, art, or decisions and want structured feedback.

They may choose:

- Hype Me for motivation
- Advise Me for suggestions
- Soft Truth for careful critique
- Challenge Me for serious review

7.2 Secondary Users

- People recovering from rejection or embarrassment
- People who want anonymous support
- People who enjoy encouraging others
- People seeking advice from strangers
- People who want less toxic social media

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8. User Personas

Persona 1: The Overthinker

Name: Tolu
Age: 19
Need: Wants reassurance before making decisions.
Pain: Friends often dismiss their concerns.
Ichigo use case: Posts “Did I overreact?” and chooses **Soft Truth**.

Persona 2: The Ambitious Builder

Name: Maya
Age: 23
Need: Wants encouragement after making progress.

Pain: Public social media makes her feel ignored.
Ichigo use case: Posts a project update and chooses **Hype Me**.

Persona 3: The Emotional Venter

Name: Daniel
Age: 21
Need: Wants to feel heard, not fixed.
Pain: People always give advice when he just wants comfort.
Ichigo use case: Posts a bad-day rant and chooses **Comfort Me**.

Persona 4: The Self-Improver

Name: Amara
Age: 25
Need: Wants honest feedback but not cruelty.
Pain: Online criticism can be unnecessarily harsh.
Ichigo use case: Posts a personal dilemma and chooses **Challenge Me**.

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9. Core Product Concept

Every post on Ichigo has two parts:

1. **The content** — what the user wants to share.
2. **The response mode** — how the user wants others to respond.

This response mode becomes the social rule for that post.

For example:

> "I finally submitted my first bug bounty report."
> Mode: **Hype Me**

Expected responses:

- "That is a huge step. Keep going."
- "You are building real momentum."
- "Submitting is progress already."

Not acceptable in that mode:

- "It will probably get rejected."
- "This is not impressive."
- "You should have done more research."

But if the same post was under **Challenge Me**, constructive critique would be allowed.

10. Response Modes

10.1 Hype Me

Purpose: Boost confidence, celebrate, energize.

Best for:

- Achievements
- Progress updates
- Creative work
- Personal wins
- Motivation

Allowed responses:

- Praise
- Encouragement
- Celebration
- Confidence-building

Disallowed responses:

- Harsh criticism
- Minimizing the achievement
- Sarcasm
- Unrequested correction

10.2 Comfort Me

Purpose: Emotional support and reassurance.

Best for:

- Bad days
- Rejection
- Anxiety
- Sadness
- Embarrassment
- Feeling behind

Allowed responses:

- Empathy
- Warmth
- Reassurance
- Gentle reflection

Disallowed responses:

- Blame
- Shaming
- Aggressive advice
- “Just get over it” style comments

10.3 Advise Me

Purpose: Practical suggestions.

Best for:

- Decisions
- Confusion
- Planning
- Situational questions
- Career/school/life choices

Allowed responses:

- Suggestions
- Options
- Pros and cons
- Personal experience

Disallowed responses:

- Empty hype
- Judgment without advice
- Hostility
- Overly harsh criticism

10.4 Soft Truth

Purpose: Honest feedback delivered gently.

Best for:

- Conflicts
- Self-reflection
- Relationship issues
- Mistakes
- Moral uncertainty

Allowed responses:

- Gentle disagreement

- Balanced perspective
- Carefully worded truth
- Constructive correction

Disallowed responses:

- Insults
- Brutal honesty as cruelty
- Mockery
- Pile-ons

10.5 Challenge Me

Purpose: Stronger critical feedback for users who explicitly ask for it.

Best for:

- Ideas
- Arguments
- Work submissions
- Public opinions
- Strategy
- Personal blind spots

Allowed responses:

- Direct critique
- Counterarguments
- Risk analysis
- Logical challenge

Disallowed responses:

- Personal attacks
- Abuse
- Hate
- Dogpiling
- Off-topic negativity

10.6 Just Listen

Purpose: Let the user express without receiving advice or judgment.

Best for:

- Venting
- Processing emotions
- Sharing pain

- Reflective posts

Allowed responses:

- “I hear you.”
- “That sounds heavy.”
- “Thank you for sharing this.”

Disallowed responses:

- Advice
- Correction
- Debate
- Dismissal

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11. MVP Scope

11.1 MVP Goal

Validate whether users want to post with explicit response modes and whether other users are willing to respond according to those modes.

11.2 MVP Platforms

Start with one platform:

- Mobile-first web app

Then expand to:

- iOS app
- Android app

11.3 MVP Features

User accounts

- Sign up / login
- Username
- Profile avatar
- Optional anonymous display mode

Create post

Fields:

- Post text

- Response mode
- Optional tags
- Visibility: public, followers, group, anonymous

Feed

- Main feed of posts
- Filter by response mode
- Filter by tags
- Sort by newest or active

Comments

- Users comment under posts
- Comment box shows the selected response mode rules
- Comments can be rated by the poster and community

Response quality rating

Poster can rate a response:

- Matched what I needed
- Helpful
- Did not match mode
- Harmful or inappropriate

Reputation score

Users gain reputation for helpful, mode-aligned responses.

Moderation

- Report comment
- Hide comment
- Basic automated toxicity detection
- Manual review queue for flagged content

AI assistant layer

Optional MVP feature:

- AI suggests mode-aligned reply drafts
- AI warns before posting if comment may violate the selected mode

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12. Post Creation Flow

1. User opens Ichigo.

2. User taps “Create Post.”
3. User writes what they want to share.
4. User selects response mode.
5. App shows short mode explanation.
6. User chooses visibility.
7. User posts.
8. Other users see the post with the response mode badge.
9. Responders comment within the mode.
10. Poster rates responses.
11. Reputation updates.

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13. Example User Flows

13.1 Hype Flow

User posts:

> “I finally launched my portfolio website.”

Mode:

> Hype Me

The app prompts responders:

> This user wants encouragement and celebration. Avoid criticism unless they ask for it.

Good response:

> “This is a big step. Launching is already more than most people do.”

13.2 Soft Truth Flow

User posts:

> “I ignored my friend for a week because I was angry. Was that immature?”

Mode:

> Soft Truth

Good response:

> “Your anger may be understandable, but ignoring them for a week probably made the situation worse. You can still explain how you felt and apologize for the silence.”

13.3 Challenge Flow

User posts:

> “I think my app idea will beat Reddit because it gives people the feedback they actually want.”

Mode:

> Challenge Me

Good response:

> “The insight is strong, but beating Reddit is too broad. You need a narrower wedge, like emotionally intentional feedback for students, creators, or anonymous support communities.”

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14. Reputation System

14.1 Purpose

The reputation system exists to reward users who respect emotional context and discourage those who violate response contracts.

14.2 Reputation Name Ideas

- Trust Score
- Alignment Score
- Kindness Score
- Ichigo Score
- Response Score
- Signal Score

14.3 Positive Signals

A user gains reputation when:

- Poster marks response as helpful
- Comment is rated as mode-aligned
- Comment receives positive community feedback
- User consistently avoids reports
- User responds thoughtfully, not generically

14.4 Negative Signals

A user loses reputation when:

- Comment violates response mode
- Poster marks comment as harmful
- Comment is reported and confirmed
- User insults, mocks, harasses, or derails
- User repeatedly gives unwanted advice in comfort/listening modes

14.5 Reputation Effects

Higher reputation may unlock:

- Ability to comment more often
- Higher visibility in replies
- Access to sensitive rooms
- Moderator eligibility
- Profile badges

Lower reputation may cause:

- Comment rate limits
- Comments held for review
- Temporary muting
- Loss of access to certain rooms
- Account suspension for repeated abuse

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15. Comment Moderation Rules

15.1 Universal Rules

Regardless of mode, the following should not be allowed:

- Harassment
- Hate speech
- Threats
- Sexual exploitation
- Doxxing
- Targeted abuse
- Encouragement of self-harm
- Spam
- Impersonation
- Malicious manipulation

15.2 Mode-Specific Rules

Each mode has its own allowed and disallowed response style.

Example:

In **Hype Me**, harsh critique is disallowed.

In **Challenge Me**, critique is allowed, but personal attack is still disallowed.

15.3 Moderation Layers

1. Automated toxicity detection
2. Mode alignment classifier
3. User reports
4. Poster controls
5. Human moderator review

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16. Safety and Ethics Framework

16.1 Core Ethical Principle

Ichigo may curate emotion, but it must not falsify reality.

16.2 What Ichigo Should Do

- Let users choose the kind of response they want.
- Clearly label response modes.
- Make users aware that feedback is context-shaped.
- Allow honest modes like Soft Truth and Challenge Me.
- Separate emotional support from professional mental health care.
- Provide safety resources where necessary.

16.3 What Ichigo Should Not Do

- Secretly hide disagreement while pretending feedback is neutral.
- Fabricate fake comments.
- Use bots pretending to be real humans.
- Make users believe there is universal agreement when there is not.
- Push users deeper into harmful delusions.
- Reward blind validation over thoughtful support.
- Allow dangerous advice.

16.4 Transparency Statement

Ichigo should include a clear user-facing statement:

> Ichigo lets you choose the kind of feedback you want to receive. Responses are shaped by the mode you select. Some modes prioritize comfort or encouragement, while others prioritize advice or critique.

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17. AI Role

17.1 AI as Assistant, Not Fake User

AI should not pretend to be a real human.

AI can be used for:

- Suggesting better replies
- Detecting mode violations
- Summarizing feedback
- Helping posters choose a response mode
- Offering optional first response when no human has replied

17.2 AI Reply Assistant

When a user wants to comment, AI can help rewrite the response to match the selected mode.

Example:

Original comment:

> “You were wrong. That was immature.”

For Soft Truth, AI suggests:

> “I understand why you felt hurt, but ignoring them may not have helped. A direct conversation might be better.”

17.3 AI Mode Classifier

AI can classify whether a comment matches the mode:

- Strong match
- Acceptable
- Borderline
- Violation

17.4 AI Safety Guardrails

AI should flag:

- Self-harm content
- Abuse
- Dangerous advice
- Exploitative behavior
- Severe distress
- Medical/legal/financial overreach

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18. Community Structure

18.1 Open Feed

Public posts visible to all users, with mode labels.

18.2 Rooms

Users can join themed rooms.

Example rooms:

- Small Wins
- Bad Day Comfort
- Career Anxiety
- Relationship Reflection
- Creator Feedback
- Student Stress
- Soft Truth
- Founder Ideas
- Bug Bounty Review

18.3 Room Rules

Each room can have default response modes or allowed modes.

Example:

Small Wins:

- Hype Me
- Comfort Me

Founder Ideas:

- Advise Me
- Soft Truth
- Challenge Me

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19. Privacy and Anonymity

19.1 Display Options

Users can post as:

- Public profile
- Anonymous to community
- Anonymous to everyone except platform admins

19.2 Private Accountability

Even when users appear anonymous publicly, the platform should still track abuse internally.

This prevents users from escaping consequences through anonymity.

19.3 Privacy Principles

- Do not sell private emotional data.
- Do not expose anonymous identities publicly.
- Allow users to delete posts.
- Allow users to export account data.
- Be careful with sensitive emotional content.

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20. Core Screens

20.1 Onboarding Screen

Goal: Explain Ichigo quickly.

Copy:

> Welcome to Ichigo. Share what is on your mind and choose the kind of response you need: comfort, hype, advice, soft truth, or challenge.

20.2 Mode Selection Screen

Cards:

- Hype Me
- Comfort Me
- Advise Me
- Soft Truth
- Challenge Me
- Just Listen

Each card includes:

- Short description
- Example post
- Example good response

20.3 Create Post Screen

Fields:

- What do you want to share?
- What response do you need?
- Where should this be posted?
- Post anonymously?

20.4 Feed Screen

Each post card includes:

- User/avatar or anonymous badge
- Response mode badge
- Post text
- Number of replies
- Helpful response count
- Reply button

20.5 Comment Screen

Before typing, responder sees:

> This post is in Comfort Me mode. The poster wants empathy, not advice.

20.6 Reputation Screen

Shows:

- Response Score

- Most common strengths
- Recent feedback
- Mode badges earned

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21. Feature Prioritization

Phase 1: MVP

- Accounts
- Create post
- Choose response mode
- Feed
- Comments
- Poster rating
- Basic reputation
- Reporting

Phase 2: Community Quality

- Rooms
- AI reply assistant
- Mode violation warnings
- Comment ranking by helpfulness
- Anonymous posting
- User blocking/muting

Phase 3: Growth

- Friend invites
- Shareable posts
- Streaks for helpful responses
- Creator rooms
- Private groups
- Push notifications

Phase 4: Monetization

- Premium emotional analytics
- Private rooms
- Advanced AI response coach
- Creator/community tools
- Custom response modes

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22. Monetization Strategy

22.1 Freemium Model

Free:

- Create posts
- Use basic modes
- Comment
- Join public rooms

Premium:

- Advanced modes
- Private rooms
- AI response assistant
- Deep feedback summaries
- Mood and feedback history
- Custom response filters

22.2 Creator/Community Plans

For creators, coaches, teachers, or small communities:

- Private feedback spaces
- Moderation dashboard
- Custom room rules
- Member reputation analytics

22.3 Ethical Monetization Boundaries

Ichigo should not monetize by:

- Selling emotional vulnerability data
- Boosting addictive insecurity loops
- Creating fake validation
- Paywalling urgent safety support

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23. Metrics and KPIs

23.1 Activation Metrics

- Signup completion rate
- First post creation rate
- First response received rate
- Mode selection completion rate

23.2 Engagement Metrics

- Posts per active user
- Comments per post
- Helpful responses per post
- Return rate after receiving feedback
- Room participation

23.3 Quality Metrics

- Percentage of comments rated mode-aligned
- Reports per 1,000 comments
- Harmful comment rate
- Poster satisfaction score
- Responder reputation growth

23.4 Retention Metrics

- Day 1 retention
- Day 7 retention
- Day 30 retention
- Weekly active users
- Repeat posting rate

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24. Technical Architecture

24.1 Recommended MVP Stack

Frontend:

- React Native or Flutter for mobile
- Or Next.js for mobile-first web MVP

Backend:

- Node.js with NestJS/Express
- Or Python FastAPI

Database:

- PostgreSQL

Cache / Queue:

- Redis

Authentication:

- Email/password
- Google login
- Apple login for iOS later

AI Layer:

- LLM API for classification and rewrite suggestions
- Moderation model for toxicity and safety checks

Storage:

- S3-compatible object storage for avatars/media

24.2 Core Services

- Auth Service
- User Service
- Post Service
- Comment Service
- Mode Classification Service
- Reputation Service
- Moderation Service
- Notification Service
- AI Assistant Service

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25. Data Model Draft

25.1 Users

Fields:

- id
- username
- email
- password_hash
- avatar_url
- bio
- reputation_score
- created_at
- updated_at

25.2 Posts

Fields:

- id
- user_id
- content
- response_mode
- visibility
- room_id
- is_anonymous
- status
- created_at
- updated_at

25.3 Comments

Fields:

- id
- post_id
- user_id
- content
- mode_alignment_score
- status
- created_at
- updated_at

25.4 Ratings

Fields:

- id
- comment_id
- rated_by_user_id
- rating_type
- created_at

Rating types:

- helpful
- matched_mode
- did_not_match_mode
- harmful

25.5 Rooms

Fields:

- id
- name
- description
- default_modes
- visibility
- created_by
- created_at

25.6 Reports

Fields:

- id
- target_type
- target_id
- reporter_id
- reason
- status
- created_at

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26. API Endpoint Draft

Auth

- POST /auth/register
- POST /auth/login
- POST /auth/logout
- GET /auth/me

Users

- GET /users/:id
- PATCH /users/me
- GET /users/me/reputation

Posts

- POST /posts
- GET /posts/feed
- GET /posts/:id
- DELETE /posts/:id

Comments

- POST /posts/:id/comments
- GET /posts/:id/comments
- PATCH /comments/:id
- DELETE /comments/:id

Ratings

- POST /comments/:id/rate

Rooms

- POST /rooms
- GET /rooms
- GET /rooms/:id
- POST /rooms/:id/join
- POST /rooms/:id/leave

Reports

- POST /reports
- GET /moderation/reports
- PATCH /moderation/reports/:id

AI

- POST /ai/classify-comment
- POST /ai/rewrite-comment
- POST /ai/suggest-mode

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27. Mode Alignment Logic

27.1 Classification Inputs

The classifier should consider:

- Post content
- Selected response mode
- Comment content
- Prior conversation context
- Room rules

27.2 Output

The model returns:

- alignment_score: 0–100
- classification: match / acceptable / borderline / violation
- reason
- suggested_rewrite

27.3 Example

Post mode:

> Comfort Me

Comment:

> “You should stop being sensitive and move on.”

Output:

- alignment_score: 15
- classification: violation
- reason: dismissive and not comforting
- suggested_rewrite: “That sounds painful. It makes sense that it affected you.”

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28. Launch Strategy

28.1 Wedge Market

Do not launch as a broad social network immediately.

Start with one narrow community where feedback mismatch is common.

Possible wedges:

1. Students dealing with stress and social comparison
2. Young professionals sharing wins and setbacks
3. Creators seeking emotional feedback
4. Founders sharing ideas
5. Anonymous support communities
6. Bug bounty / builder communities needing feedback modes

28.2 Recommended Initial Wedge

Best initial wedge:

Creators, students, and builders who want emotionally appropriate feedback.

This group has both emotional and practical use cases.

28.3 Go-To-Market

- Private beta
- Invite-only rooms
- Campus/community ambassadors
- TikTok/X content around “what response did you actually need?”
- Shareable screenshots of mode-based feedback
- Founder-led community building

28.4 Viral Loops

- Share a post externally with mode badge
- Invite friends to respond in a specific mode
- “Someone wants your advice” notifications
- “Your response helped someone” notifications
- Public profile badges for good responders

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29. Competitive Differentiation

Ichigo is not just:

- Anonymous compliments
- AI therapy
- Reddit advice
- Comment filtering
- Social media moderation

Ichigo is different because:

1. Every post carries an explicit emotional context.
2. Response modes create social contracts.
3. Reputation rewards emotional alignment.
4. Users choose what type of feedback they are ready for.
5. The platform balances comfort with truth-based modes.

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30. Risks

30.1 Ethical Risk

Risk:

Users may use the app only to seek validation and avoid reality.

Mitigation:

- Include truth-based modes.
- Be transparent about emotional framing.
- Do not fabricate consensus.
- Encourage users to choose different modes depending on context.

30.2 Moderation Risk

Risk:

Anonymous users may abuse others.

Mitigation:

- Internal identity/account tracking
- Reputation penalties
- Rate limits
- Strong reporting
- AI moderation
- Human review

30.3 Retention Risk

Risk:

Users may post once, get feedback, and leave.

Mitigation:

- Rooms
- Streaks
- Follow system
- Notifications
- Reputation progression
- Recurring prompts

30.4 Trust Risk

Risk:

Users may feel the app is fake or overly controlled.

Mitigation:

- Make response modes transparent.
- Allow users to view filtered/borderline comments if appropriate.
- Avoid fake users and fake comments.

30.5 Safety Risk

Risk:

Users may post crisis content.

Mitigation:

- Crisis detection
- Escalation flows
- Safety resources
- Limit unqualified advice
- Flag dangerous replies

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31. Product Principles

1. **Consent over manipulation**
   Users should know how the feedback environment works.

2. **Emotion without deception**
   The platform can support emotional needs without falsifying reality.

3. **Context matters**
   The same comment can be useful in one mode and harmful in another.

4. **Reward good responders**
   Social value comes from meeting people where they are.

5. **Truth should remain available**
   Comfort modes should not erase the existence of reality-check modes.

6. **Anonymity with accountability**
   Users can be anonymous publicly, but not consequence-free internally.

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32. MVP Validation Plan

32.1 Core Hypotheses

Hypothesis 1:

Users want to choose the kind of response they receive.

Hypothesis 2:

Users are willing to respond according to another person’s selected mode.

Hypothesis 3:

Mode-based feedback increases user satisfaction compared to ordinary comments.

Hypothesis 4:

Reputation can improve comment quality.

32.2 Validation Tests

Test 1: Landing Page

Create a landing page explaining Ichigo and collect emails.

Measure:

- Conversion rate
- Most selected use case
- Which mode users are most interested in

Test 2: Manual Community Prototype

Use Discord, Telegram, or WhatsApp.

Create channels:

- Hype Me
- Comfort Me
- Advise Me
- Soft Truth
- Challenge Me

Manually observe whether people understand and follow rules.

Test 3: No-Code MVP

Use a simple web form and feed.

Users post with selected mode.

Comments are manually or semi-automatically moderated.

Test 4: AI-Assisted Prototype

Build a small app where AI classifies whether comments match the selected mode.

Measure:

- Classification accuracy
- User satisfaction
- Number of violations prevented

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33. Roadmap

Month 1: Research and Prototype

- Finalize modes
- Create landing page
- Run interviews
- Build design mockups
- Start manual community test

Month 2: MVP Build

- Auth
- Posting
- Mode selection
- Feed
- Comments
- Rating
- Basic moderation

Month 3: Private Beta

- Invite first 100–500 users
- Monitor response quality
- Improve mode definitions
- Add basic reputation
- Collect feedback

Month 4–6: Public Beta

- Add rooms
- Add AI mode classifier
- Add notifications
- Add shareable posts
- Improve onboarding

Month 6+

- Mobile app
- Premium features
- Creator/community tools
- Advanced analytics
- Scale moderation

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34. Example Copy

34.1 Onboarding Copy

> Sometimes you do not need advice. Sometimes you need comfort. Sometimes you need hype. Sometimes you need the truth, but gently. Ichigo lets you choose the kind of response you are ready for.

34.2 Create Post Prompt

> What do you want to share?

34.3 Mode Prompt

> What kind of response would help you right now?

34.4 Comment Prompt

> This post is in Soft Truth mode. Be honest, but be gentle.

34.5 Reputation Copy

> Your responses helped 18 people feel understood this week.

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35. Open Questions

1. Should Ichigo be anonymous-first or identity-first?
2. Should AI be allowed to reply directly, or only assist humans?

3. Should users be able to create custom response modes?
4. Should hidden/misaligned comments be visible to posters if they choose?
5. What age group should be targeted first?
6. Should the first market be students, creators, founders, or general social users?
7. How strict should reputation penalties be?
8. Should rooms be public or invite-only at launch?
9. Should the brand feel playful, serious, or calming?
10. What exact emotional problem should the landing page emphasize first?

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36. Recommended Next Steps

1. Choose the first target audience.
2. Finalize 5 core response modes for MVP.
3. Create a landing page.
4. Run 10–20 user interviews.
5. Build a manual community prototype.
6. Test whether users naturally understand response modes.
7. Build a simple MVP only after demand is validated.

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37. Additional Execution Requirements

The original documentation defines the product well, but the following areas should be added before serious development begins.

37.1 Age Policy

Ichigo should not be designed for young children.

Recommended policy:

- Minimum age: 16+ or 18+, depending on legal jurisdiction and launch market.
- If teens are allowed, they should have a more restricted experience than adults.
- Users below the minimum age should not be onboarded.
- Teen users should have stronger safety defaults, stricter moderation, and limited exposure to anonymous strangers.

Why this matters:

Ichigo deals with emotional interpretation, identity, social approval, and self-perception. Younger children may not clearly distinguish between emotional framing, opinion, social validation, and objective truth.

37.2 Informed Consent and Product Transparency

Ichigo should make the response-mode mechanic clear during onboarding.

The user should understand that:

- Response modes shape the type of replies they receive.
- Hype or comfort modes do not represent objective public consensus.
- Truth-based modes are available when users want more honest feedback.
- The app is designed for emotionally appropriate feedback, not reality replacement.

Suggested onboarding copy:

> Ichigo lets you choose the type of feedback you want. Some modes prioritize support. Some prioritize advice. Some prioritize honest challenge. You are choosing a response context, not an objective verdict.

37.3 Abuse and Misuse Cases

Ichigo should explicitly plan for misuse.

Potential misuse cases:

1. A user posts harmful behavior and selects Hype Me to seek praise.
2. A user uses Comfort Me to avoid accountability.
3. A group coordinates to validate dangerous or false beliefs.
4. Users exploit anonymity to harass others.
5. Users use the app to manipulate sympathy.
6. Users become dependent on external validation.
7. Users try to bypass mode rules through sarcasm or coded insults.

Mitigations:

- Universal safety rules override response modes.
- Harmful content should not be validated merely because the user selected a supportive mode.
- Sensitive categories should trigger safer response templates.
- Moderation should detect coordinated abuse.
- The platform should limit repetitive validation-seeking loops.
- Posters should be encouraged to try truth-based modes when appropriate.

37.4 Universal Override Rule

Response modes should never override safety, law, or basic human dignity.

Example:

If a user posts something cruel or dangerous under Hype Me, responders should not be forced to praise it.

The app can instead show:

> This post may need advice or reflection rather than hype. Consider switching to Soft Truth or Advise Me.

This prevents the product from becoming a blind affirmation machine.

37.5 Mode Switching

Users should be allowed to change the response mode after posting, but the change should be visible.

Example:

> Mode changed from Hype Me to Soft Truth.

This prevents confusion and preserves trust with responders.

37.6 Comment Visibility Controls

The app should define what happens to mode-violating comments.

Options:

- Hide by default but allow the poster to view them.
- Place them under “Misaligned replies.”
- Allow moderators to remove harmful comments completely.
- Let posters choose whether to receive borderline replies.

Recommended default:

- Harmful comments should be removed or hidden.
- Merely misaligned comments should be separated, not erased.

This preserves transparency without forcing users to read unwanted feedback.

37.7 AI Disclosure

If AI assists with responses, users should know.

AI can help with:

- Drafting comments
- Rewriting harsh replies
- Suggesting response modes
- Summarizing feedback
- Detecting safety risks

AI should not:

- Pretend to be a real human
- Generate fake community consensus
- Fabricate supportive comments
- Manipulate users into staying longer

Suggested rule:

> AI may assist the conversation, but it must not impersonate the community.

37.8 Data Privacy and Emotional Data

Ichigo will handle sensitive emotional data, even when the content is not legally classified as medical data.

The privacy policy should be strict from day one.

Ichigo should avoid:

- Selling emotional vulnerability data
- Allowing advertisers to target users based on sadness, loneliness, insecurity, heartbreak, anxiety, or distress
- Using private posts to train models without clear consent
- Exposing anonymous identities without due process or legal necessity

Ichigo should provide:

- Data deletion
- Account deletion
- Clear privacy settings
- Anonymous posting controls
- Minimal data collection
- Transparent AI data usage policy

37.9 Moderation Workflow

A clearer moderation workflow is needed.

Suggested flow:

1. Comment is submitted.
2. Automated system checks for universal safety violations.
3. Mode-alignment classifier checks whether the comment fits the selected response mode.
4. If safe and aligned, comment is posted normally.
5. If safe but misaligned, comment may be delayed, rewritten, or placed in a lower-visibility area.
6. If unsafe, comment is blocked or sent to review.
7. Repeated violations reduce reputation.

8. Severe violations trigger suspension or ban.

37.10 Reputation Abuse Prevention

A reputation system can be gamed.

Potential attacks:

- Friends artificially upvote each other.
- Users write generic praise to farm reputation.
- Groups mass-report people they dislike.
- Users create multiple accounts to reset reputation.
- Users avoid honest feedback because they fear penalties.

Mitigations:

- Weight ratings from trusted users more heavily.
- Detect suspicious rating clusters.
- Penalize confirmed false reports.
- Track device/account abuse internally.
- Reward specificity and helpfulness, not just positivity.
- Separate “kindness reputation” from “truthfulness reputation.”

37.11 Product Tone and Brand Boundary

Ichigo should avoid language that makes the product sound like a delusion engine.

Avoid:

- “Only hear what you want.”
- “Escape reality.”
- “No negativity ever.”
- “Guaranteed validation.”

Prefer:

- “Choose the feedback you are ready for.”
- “Share with emotional context.”
- “Support, advice, or truth — your choice.”
- “Feedback that meets you where you are.”

37.12 Landing Page Structure

A first landing page should include:

1. Hero statement

Feedback that meets you where you are.

1. Short explanation

   Post what is on your mind and choose the kind of response you need: hype, comfort, advice, soft truth, or challenge.

1. Example interaction

Post:

> I finally launched my first project.

Mode:

> Hype Me

Response:

> That is a real milestone. Most people never launch. Keep going.

1. Ethical trust statement

   Ichigo does not fake reality. It helps you choose the emotional context of your feedback.

1. Waitlist form

   Join the private beta.

37.13 First 30-Day Founder Plan

Week 1:

- Define first target audience.
- Finalize MVP modes.
- Write landing page copy.
- Create simple brand mockups.

Week 2:

- Interview 10–20 potential users.
- Ask what kind of feedback they wish they received online.
- Test whether the term “response mode” is understandable.

Week 3:

- Create a manual Discord, Telegram, or WhatsApp prototype.
- Use channels or tags for each response mode.

- Manually moderate comments.

Week 4:

- Measure usage.
- Identify most used modes.
- Identify moderation pain points.
- Decide whether to build the MVP.

37.14 Investor-Ready Summary

Ichigo is an emotion-aware social feedback platform.

The core insight is that social media optimizes for engagement, but not for emotional fit. Ichigo allows users to attach a response mode to every post, creating an explicit social contract between poster and responder.

The product begins with five core modes: Hype Me, Comfort Me, Advise Me, Soft Truth, and Challenge Me.

The wedge is users who want to share online but fear receiving the wrong kind of feedback. The long-term opportunity is to build a new social layer where feedback is contextual, consent-based, and emotionally intelligent.

37.15 Key Product Question

The most important validation question is:

> Will users post more honestly and return more often when they can control the emotional context of replies?

If the answer is yes, Ichigo has a real behavioral wedge.

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38. Final Product Definition

Ichigo is an intentional feedback platform.

It helps users share thoughts, emotions, questions, decisions, and wins while choosing the kind of response they are emotionally ready to receive.

Its core innovation is the **response mode**: a social contract attached to every post.

Ichigo is not about hiding reality. It is about matching feedback to emotional context.

> **Ichigo: feedback that meets you where you are.**